

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Ideation Phase: Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

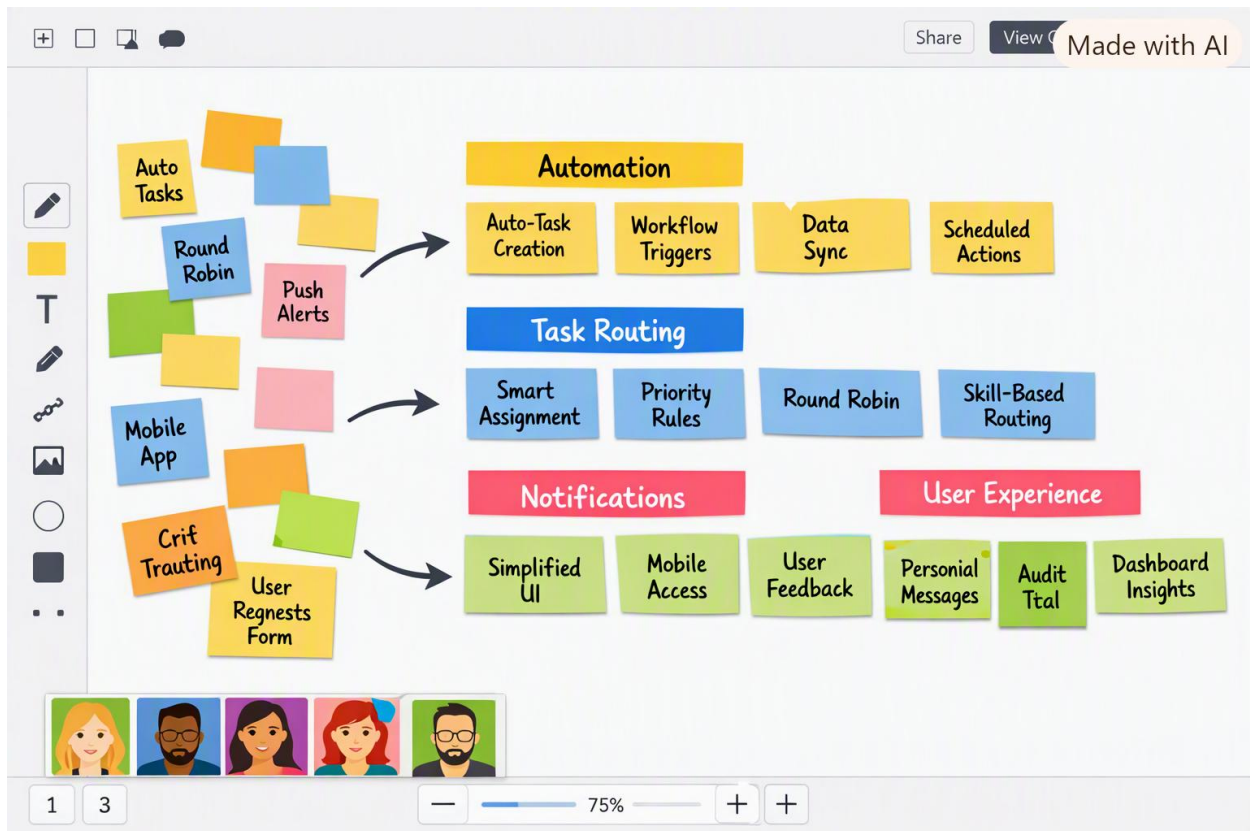
Date:	October 3, 2026	Maximum Marks:	4 Marks
Team ID:	SWTID-2026-2585	Project Name:	Standard Laptop Automation

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Step 1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

- Objective: Align team members on project scope, remote collaboration tools (Mural/Miro), and confirm the core IT procurement challenge.
- **Selected Problem Statement:** The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests often require manual configuration tracking, leading to user frustration and resource bottlenecks.



Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

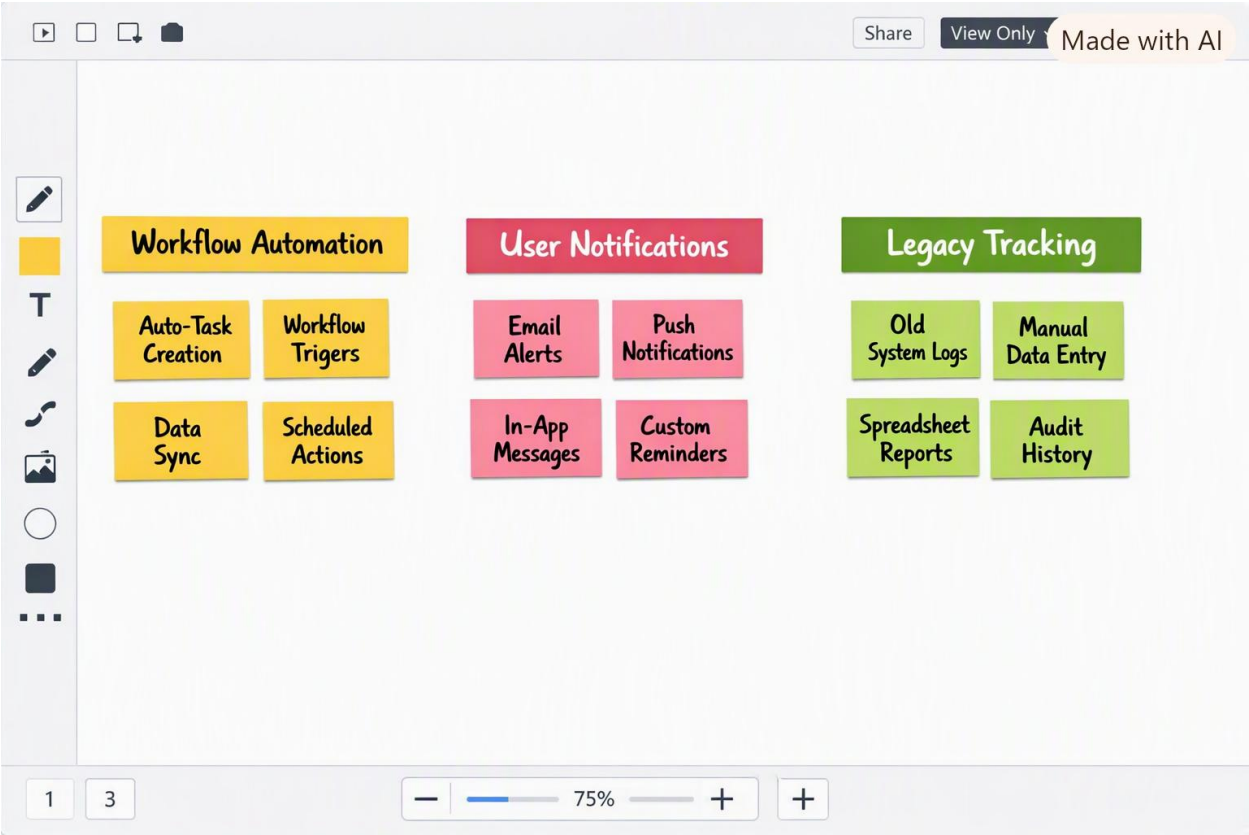
- **Brainstorming Technique:** Open ideation focusing on maximum volume of ideas, followed by thematic affinity clustering.

- **Generated Ideas (Raw List):**

1. Implement automated email notifications for approvers.
2. Use ServiceNow Flow Designer to trigger automatic catalog tasks upon approval [cite: 2].
3. Create an Excel macro to track laptop serial numbers.
4. Auto-assign configuration tasks directly to the Hardware team group [cite: 2].
5. Build a chatbot for users to check order status.
6. Require manual manager sign-off via physical paper forms.

- **Idea Grouping (Thematic Clusters):**

- Cluster A (Automation & Workflow): Ideas #2, #4 (Flow Designer integration & automatic group task assignment).
- Cluster B (Communication & Visibility): Ideas #1, #5 (Notifications and status tracking).
- Cluster C (Manual / Legacy Methods): Ideas #3, #6 (Spreadsheets and paper forms — deprioritized).



Step 3: Idea Prioritization

To evaluate and select the most impactful solutions, ideas were mapped on an Impact vs. Feasibility matrix (scored from High, Medium, Low).

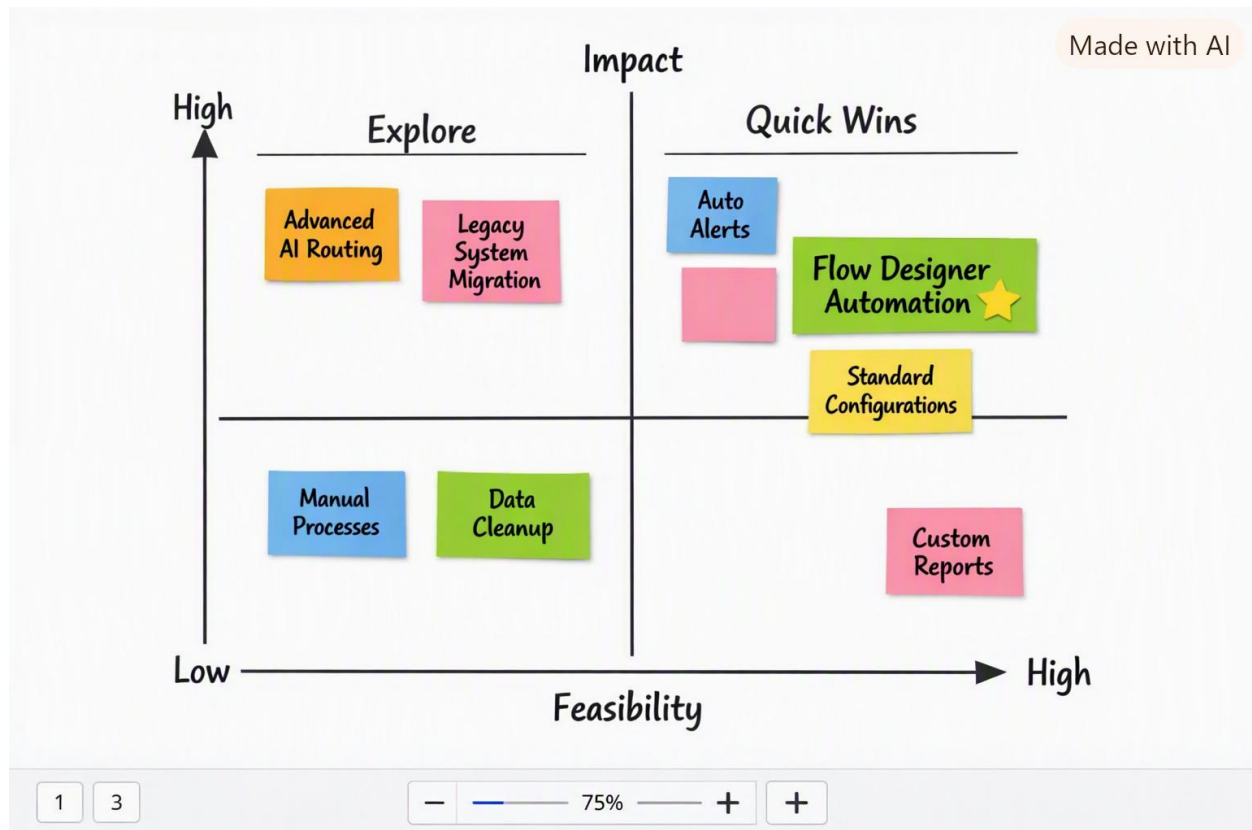
Idea Description	Impact	Feasibility	Priority / Action
ServiceNow Flow Designer for automated Catalog Task creation & Hardware assignment [cite: 2]	High	High	Top Priority (Selected)
Automated email alerts for approval notifications & status updates	Medium	High	Secondary / Phase 2

Self-service chatbot for order tracking and inquiries

Medium

Low

Backlog



Alignment

- Project Context: Aligns directly with Milestone 1 & 2 of the 'Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer' project [cite: 2].